Monday, November 13

One hundred US officials from the State Department signed a document dissenting with the president's policy in the Israel-Hamas war and accusing Joe Biden of spreading misinformation when, three days after Hamas's attack, he characterized it as "pure evil." It is interesting to note that the State Department has traditionally been anti-Israeli and, during World War II, antisemitic (Breckinridge Long), when it tried to impede immigration to the United Stares of Jews fleeing for their lives.

It is perplexing, somewhat unsettling, and sad to witness these substantial instances of antisemitism suddenly popping up in so many places, including from within the State Department. This is not frightening anymore, as it was for centuries, but certainly perplexing. Why this hatred? I won't start answering here: it demands more than a few sentences, and a lot of thought. Apart from the State Department example, there is the notorious one of the Harvard student organizations. That, however, has triggered the response of some 1,600 Jewish alumni who now threaten to end their donations. That will probably rattle the university's leadership.

During the last two weeks, as all attention has concentrated on the fighting in Gaza, a low-level war has ensued on the Israeli-Lebanese border, with Hezbollah and Israel exchanging fire and inflicting casualties on both sides.

A strange symmetry: more than 70 percent of Gazans were critical of Hamas and wanted a peaceful agreement with Israel, according to a poll by Foreign Affairs taken just before October 7. And about 70 percent of Israelis wish to be rid of Netanyahu and his coalition, and want a center-right government, probably under Gantz. Although there is no desire for negotiations with the Palestinians, the very fact that we shall get rid of Netanyahu and his coalition will open many possibilities.

According to Defense Minister Gallant, Hamas has lost control in the northern part of Gaza; the inhabitants are looting the organization's reserves